supersession of the rigidities of the Cold War era. Therefore, efforts to set expectations that are modelled on the relationship that the US had with its Western partners should be resisted. Nor should we readily accept the opposite paradigm, that of a purely transactional arrangement. Each one of the Quad partners has its own culture and tradition, but the fact is that there is a strong democratic overlap. Fortunately, the governments in question have all shown a maturity that would, hopefully, also percolate more deeply into the public discourse.

The Quad is the aggregate of the progress India has made in key relationships over two decades. It is also an assertion of going beyond traditional confines and set working habits. That it has opened up so many new vistas should only encourage us to intensify it further. This coming together for an agreed agenda powered by a shared outlook is manifestly a statement of practical goodness. It is, at the same time, a revelation how a crucial landscape, when examined by a Bharat with clearer eyes, will help find its own solutions.